

▶ ADAPTING A PATTERN

Once you have determined the dimensions of the quilt you'd like to make, you may need to make some adjustments to the pattern. If you are making a quilt without a pattern you may also find the following information helpful.

NUMBER OF BLOCKS

Most quilts are made from blocks of one size. Once you have determined the size of the finished block (the size minus seam allowances), divide the total width of the quilt by that block size to find out how many blocks you will need per row. Then, divide the total length of the quilt by the block size to determine how many rows you will need. Chances are these numbers will not come out evenly, so round both numbers down. Multiply the two numbers together to determine the total number of blocks you will need for your quilt top.

MAKING UP THE DIFFERENCE

If the measurements for the number of blocks needed did not come out evenly there are several ways to remedy this. Adding borders around the quilt top (see pp.80–83) to make up the difference is the easiest way. Adding sashings between the blocks, or making them wider if they are already part of the design, can also make up the difference (see pp.78–79), but this will alter the look of the quilt top. The third, and most difficult, option is to change the size of the blocks until they meet your requirements.

FABRIC REQUIREMENTS

If altering a pattern, it is important to take these changes into consideration when purchasing your fabrics for the quilt. It is usually a good idea to purchase more fabric than you need anyway, to allow for shrinkage during pre-washing and also for any mistakes when cutting or sewing. Don't forget to add any extra fabric you might need for the backing and binding, too.

Most quilts hang a bit below the depth of the mattress. The type of bed should also be taken into consideration when planning your quilt. Daybeds will only need extra to hang down on one side, for example.



Determine how you'd like the quilt to sit on the bed, as well as what it will be used for. For example, baby quilts are very often too small for a standard size bed, but still add a personal touch when on display.

